

Council Meeting
May 22, 2019
Page 1

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, May 22, 2019, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present were:

At-Large Councilor Claire Lessard
Ward I Councilor Andrew O'Hearne
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone
Assistant Mayor Allen Damren
Mayor Charlene Lovett
At-Large Councilor Abigail Kier
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Ward II Councilor Scott Pope

Also present:

John MacLean, Interim City Manager
Mary Walter, Finance Director

Members of the Council absent were:
At-Large Councilor Jeremy Zullo

AGENDA CHANGES

Mayor Lovett asked that item 10C, Build Grant – Pleasant Street, be moved to the second meeting in June.

REPORT OF SECRETARY

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Stone to accept the minutes of April 10, 2019; city council meeting as amended.

- a. page 7- second line should read discussion rather than decision**
- b. page 8 - "maybe we should discuss" rather than discussion**
- c. page 8 above CFMA gift - Mr. MacLean**

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0 with 1 abstaining (Ms. Kier)

A motion was made by Mr. O’Hearne and seconded by Mr. Stone to accept the minutes of the April 23, 2019, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 6-0 with 2 abstaining (Mayor Lovett & Ms. Kier)

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Stone to accept the minutes of the April 24, 2019, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 6-0 with 1 abstaining (Mayor Lovett)

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Damren to accept the minutes of the May 8, 2019, City Council meeting as amended.

- a. page 2 - delete on Monday when referring to training**
- b. under Proclamation Mental Health Awareness Month, 2nd paragraph - Suellen Griffin, Executive Director of West Central Behavioral Health**
- c. under Proclamation SHS Alumni, 1st sentence - SHS Alumni Association**
- d. page 3 - Mayor Lovett at the state house for the Senate Finance Committee hearing on the proposed budget.**

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0

A motion was made by Mr. O’Hearne and seconded by Ms. Kier to accept the minutes of the May 11, 2019, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0

MAYOR’S NOTES

Military Appreciation Month

Mayor Lovett read a proclamation making the month of May Military Appreciation month. Memorial Day Parade will start at 10:00am on Monday and will culminate with a ceremony at the memorial in Broad Street Park. Hopes everyone will come out.

PROCLAMATION

NATIONAL MILITARY APPRECIATION MONTH

WHEREAS, National Military Appreciation Month (NMAM) is celebrated every May and is a declaration that encourages U.S. citizens to observe the month in symbol of unity; and

WHEREAS, this month honors the current and former members of the U.S. Armed Forces, including those who have died in the pursuit of freedom; and

Council Meeting
May 22, 2019
Page 3

WHEREAS, the people of Claremont have had a long and proud history of serving their nation; and,

WHEREAS, the City is home to American Legion Post 29, Veterans of Foreign Wars Post 808 and Rolling Thunder Chapter 2, all committed to honoring the contributions and sacrifices of our veterans; and

WHEREAS, citizens and organizations in Claremont act often to demonstrate their gratitude for our veterans; and

WHEREAS, this Monday, May 27, is Memorial Day.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED, that I, Charlene Lovett, Mayor of the City of Claremont, do hereby proclaim the month of May as National Military Appreciation Month and do hereby call upon our citizens to join the City of Claremont in honoring our veterans and the contributions they have made to our nation and to our community.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, I have hereunto set my hand and caused the Seal of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, to be affixed on this 22nd day of May, 2019.

National Public Works Week

Mayor Lovett said we starting recognizing National Public Works week last year. DPW is a vital part of our community. Mayor Lovett presented Victor St. Pierre an award he earned from the NH Water Works Association for his work on Claremont Water Distribution System. Former Director Scott Sweet submitted the paperwork last year. Commended him and his staff for the work, not only on roads but on the city's water and sewer distribution systems and delivering clean water to the citizens of Claremont.

PROCLAMATION

NATIONAL PUBLIC WORKS WEEK

WHEREAS, public works services are vital to the health, safety, and well-being of the citizens of Claremont, New Hampshire; and

WHEREAS, these services can only be provided through dedicated public works professionals – including government and private sector employees who oversee water distribution, water treatment, wastewater treatment, sewer systems, equipment services, public properties, solid waste systems, city streets, and water utilities; and

WHEREAS, the President, Congress, and the Department of Homeland Security recognize that public works is an essential member of the first responder team in emergency management – prepared and equipped to safeguard lives and reduce or repair damaged critical infrastructure; and

WHEREAS, the year 2019 marks the 59th annual National Public Works Week sponsored by the American Public Works Association; and

WHEREAS, this year's theme's, "It Starts Here" acknowledges that infrastructure, growth and innovation, mobility,

Council Meeting
May 22, 2019
Page 4

security and healthy communities start with public works;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED, that I, Charlene Lovett, Mayor of the City of Claremont, do hereby proclaim the week of May 19 through May 25, 2019, as Public Works Week in Claremont, New Hampshire, in recognition of the many contributions that our public work employees make in protecting our community's health, safety and quality of life.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, I have hereunto set my hand and caused the Seal of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, to be affixed on this 22nd day of May, 2019.

Mayor Lovett said she was invited to a Commemoration of NH Lafayette Day. Out of 234 cities and towns in NH, Claremont was 1 of only 17 that Lafayette visited in his farewell tour. She gave a brief history on Lafayette and his impact on the Revolution.

Mayor Lovett spoke about the Rethink Pleasant Street meeting that took place yesterday (May 21). She said it was well received and thanked those that came out.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Mr. MacLean echoed the congratulations to Victor St. Pierre on his award. Also wanted to congratulate both Ricky Blake and Scott Baker for their certifications.

Release of right of refusal – 61 High St --Mr. MacLean gave a brief explanation of how this came about and then read the letter in the record.

Motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Stone to authorize the city manager to sign the letter and send to Mr. & Mrs. Hebert.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

None

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Victor St. Pierre gave an update regarding the boat landing, we have had issues with the culvert and the road has been closed for a time. The culvert needs to be replaced but the water has been higher than the culvert! Public Works staff has graded the whole area, cleaned as much of the boat ramp as we are allowed, and brought the brush hog down. A lot of work was done and it was completed today.

Chuck Allen, Ward 3, Arrowhead Recreation Group, gave his annual report on Arrowhead. It's 100% volunteer run and, from 2000 through 2019, has made about \$500,000 in improvements.

There are many capital needs (1960's era windows need replacing, doors, heating system, roof and it needs A/C). Reported that they had an okay year. Said they put a new deck on which added about \$15K in value. They had 39 operating days this season with 4,516 visits. On Tuesday May 28th Arrowhead is having their meeting and really need community members to come and see how they can help keep this community gem operating into the future.

OLD BUSINESS

City Manager Search Update

Mr. Damren said last meeting was last Thursday (5/16) and we have received 41 applications to date. We have reviewed 26 applications and have pulled 4 and will review the others we've received when we meet tomorrow night. The meeting will be held here in the council chambers. All of our advertising is done and we spent about \$2,000 in total. June 4th is the application deadline. He also stated Primex will be able to meet with us after the deadline to help with questions.

Food Truck Policy Ordinance 567 – First Reading – Public Hearing

Mayor Lovett said this was before the council in April and was sent back to the Policy Committee. On May 16th the Policy Committee met with the planner, staff, vendors and we had several people there. Feels questions and policy has been thoroughly vetted, sent back to legal for changes and that's what is being presented tonight.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Kier to approve Ordinance #567 Establish Food Truck Ordinance for second reading.

Mr. O'Hearne stated that there is supposed to be a City Manager's explanation attached, and this does not have one.

Motion and second were withdrawn.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Kier to suspend council rules to allow the First Reading of Food Truck Policy Ordinance #567.

Roll call vote:

Lessard – yes

O'Hearne – no

Stone – yes

Damren – yes

Kier – yes

Koloski – yes

Pope – yes

Lovett – yes

Motion carried 7-1

Mr. Koloski asked if a councilor sees something is missing in the packet that they please say something ahead of time so it does not delay the projects.

A Motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Pope to approve Ordinance #567 Food Truck Policy on first reading.

Voice Vote: motion carries 8-0

NEW BUSINESS

Sullivan County ATV Club – Request permission for Sunset Ride Events

Steve Wilkie, President of the Sullivan County ATV Club, stated he is here seeking approval to hold three scheduled guided sunset rides. He stated they will be providing sufficient notice of the date of each ride to the residents along Veteran's Park & Cat Hole Roads; Claremont Police, Fire and EMS Departments; Claremont Parks & Recreation; Department of NH Fish & Game and NH Bureau of Trails.

A motion was made by Mr. Stone and seconded by Mr. Damren to grant Sullivan County ATV Club permission to hold 1-5 Sunset Rides.

Voice vote: motion carries 8-0

Sullivan County Transitional Housing

Jeff Barrette, Ward 1 and County Commissioner Chairman stated they are looking at the old Eagle Times building at 19 Sullivan St for the sober housing. They have started the design process and hope to have cost estimates in July. They will be applying for CBDG funding in late July and hoping to have grant approval by end of year as well as a potential purchase. This facility will house 20 Males, 10 females and have a corrections staff person on site.

Mr. Dave Berry, Department of Corrections Superintendent and Donna Magee, Department of Corrections Program Director gave the presentation for Sullivan County Sober Housing TRAILS Program (Transitional Re-entry and Inmate Life Skills). Sober housing came under the umbrella of Department of Health & Human Services just in January so there is no data.

Mayor Lovett thanked them for the presentation and asked if there will be a public forum. Jeff Barrette said this is in the very early stages.

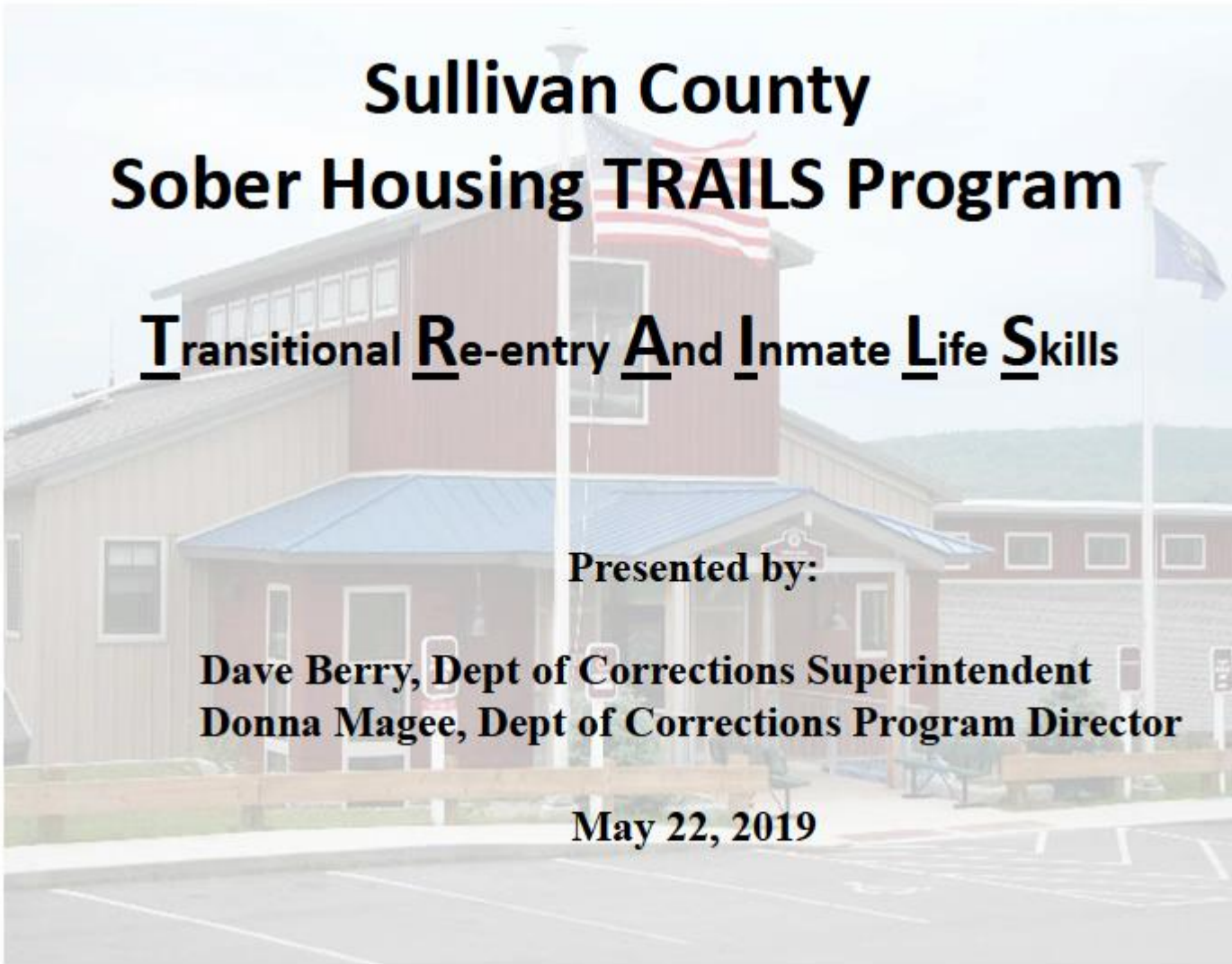
Mr. Damren asked if this would be going before the Planning Board. Director Merrill said the state has an exemption for government entities for approval but this will be a public process and comment period.

Three people who went through the system spoke of the importance of this. Whitney Davis Monique Cook just graduated from the Trails Program about 9 months ago. Tyler Cook, graduated from the TRAILS program back in September and have been clean for a year now.

Mr. MacLean said this is a very important program.

Mr. Koloski thanked the speakers for sharing their stories.

Director Merrill stated this building works well because it is walking distance to city center and services, Sullivan St is a mix of residential and businesses.



Sullivan County Sober Housing TRAILS Program

Transitional Re-entry And Inmate Life Skills

Presented by:

Dave Berry, Dept of Corrections Superintendent

Donna Magee, Dept of Corrections Program Director

May 22, 2019

Build Grant – Pleasant Street

Moved to the June 12th meeting.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Mayor Lovett stated the Policy committee will be meeting tomorrow and they need guidance from the council, regarding the Social Media Policy. It can be done as a stand- alone policy or as an update to the code of conduct policy.

A discussion followed on the necessity of the policy and the enforceability of anything we add into it. It was noted that harassment training for incoming boards members would be more beneficial. Consensus was that they did not want to spend any more funds on this and to drop the policy altogether.

Mayor Lovett said she will take back to the Policy Committee that the council does not wish to spend any money on legal fees regarding a Social Media Policy.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Mr. Damren is looking for discussion of capital improvements as he has heard several items during the budget hearings that need to be addressed and are of significant capital. While he doesn't advocate for spending all of our unutilized debt, he believes we need to look at perhaps bonding, especially since we have a bond being paid off in FY 21.

Mr. Koloski said he had not received an answer yet regarding his Fire Department ISO question and he would like to get an answer before we vote on the budget. Mr. MacLean said the ISO is working on. He does not feel that the hydrant issue would do anything to the ratings. If anything, the staffing changes made last year are more apt to impact the rating.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

NON-PUBLIC SESSION – PER RSA 91-A:3 – REAL ESTATE

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 8:52 p.m., a motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Stone to adjourn.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Gwendolyn R. Melcher
City Clerk